



A classic David vs Goliath story

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arl Pei and his brainchild brands have been known to be market disruptors.

It started with OnePlus, whose devices were marketed as flagship killers, and then it moved on to Nothing, where Pei and his crew decided to take on the heavyweights in the audio industry. After registering their presence with authority in the audio space with the Nothing Ear (1), the brand moved on to make the Nothing Phone (1), which also quickly rose to prominence. Now, they have released the second iteration of the Nothing Ear TWS earbuds, the Nothing Ear (2).

I published my review of Nothing Ear (2) last month. Since then, me and my

fellow audio reviewer, Dhriti, have spent some more time with Nothing Ear (2). Both of us have daily driven the Nothing Ear (1) in the past, and I personally found them to be working great with my Apple iPhone 12 Mini. So, a thought came to our heads - Could the Nothing Ear (2) provide better value for money than the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Gen)?

I put both the Nothing Ear (2) and the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) through our test process again. However, this time, instead of testing them as individual products, I put them in a head-to-head comparative testing process. And, the results were interesting. Continue reading this article to find

out, if the Nothing Ear (2) can give you better bang for your buck than the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) –

Build Quality and Design

One of the first things many people look at when buying a pair of TWS earbuds is their build quality. So did I when comparing the Nothing Ear (1) and the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation). Let's start with the design.

When Apple makes a product, it sticks with its basic design for at least a couple of generations. Same is the case with the AirPods Pro (2nd Generation). These earbuds came with essentially the same design as the 1st Generation AirPods Pro, sporting a pill-shaped design, sturdy, and satisfying hinge. Nothing seems to have taken a page out of Apple's book, as they too maintained the same design of the Ear (1) that had helped its rise to prominence and carried it forward to the Ear (2). There are subtle changes on the case and the earbuds, but they essentially look the same as their predecessors.

If you were to compare the case and the earbud design of the two, the Ear (2) hands down looks more attractive. That is until you start using them on a daily basis. The glossy plastic on the case starts picking up scratches, and the novelty of having a pair of earbuds with a transparent case gets covered in scratches and scuffs.

This is where AirPods get a slight lead. They have a monotone, white body, with a glossy finish. However, given that they have the same colour through and through, the scratches and scuffs that these earbuds pick up are hidden for the most part. It is only when you pick them up and closely inspect them, you realise that they have taken a beating after days of continuous use.

Talking about the case design, the materials used in the cases of both the earbuds hold their own, especially when you factor in the price. Both the cases and earbuds feel sturdy and you can put